



△ PLAY FIGHTING
Young male vicuñas often play fight and bite each other. The fights become more serious as they reach sexual maturity, and the victor will join a female-only herd to start his own family.

▽ DAILY MIGRATION
Vicuña families spend the night in the relative safety of steeper slopes. They climb back down to graze in the high plains by day.



Titicaca grebe

Rollandia microptera

So adapted to life in water that it cannot fly and can barely stand, this flightless grebe is found only on lakes in the Lake Titicaca basin. Populations on separate freshwater lakes have lived in isolation for a very long time and are vulnerable to habitat change. A few thousand pairs live on reed-fringed lakes, with areas of

open water, 9,850 ft (3,000 m) above sea level. The Titicaca grebe dives skilfully for fish—it mostly eats pupfish—and skitters across the water with raised wings. It can breed in any month of the year, making a platform of damp vegetation in which the female lays two eggs and can have several broods each year.

↔ 11–18 in (28–46 cm)

🏠 21 oz (595 g)

⊗ Endangered

🐟 Fish

🏠 🌿 🌿 🌿

W. South America



< DAGGERLIKE BILL
Grebes have sharply pointed bills. The Titicaca grebe's bill has a red upper and yellow lower mandible.

Andean flicker

Colaptes rupicola

Flickers are New World woodpeckers, noted for their terrestrial feeding behavior, and the Andean flicker is the most terrestrial of them all. It is widespread in bushy habitats and open grassland at altitudes of 6,500–16,500 ft (2,000–5,000 m).

Barbed tongue
Andean flickers feed in groups on the ground, digging or scraping around grass tussocks with their large bills to reveal ants or beetle and moth larvae. They seize their prey with the barbed tip of their long, extendable tongue. Sociable even when nesting, they build a dozen or more burrows in road cuttings or sandy or earth cliffs. The 3–5 ft (1–1.5 m) long burrows lead to a 12 in (30 cm) nesting chamber that holds up to four chicks.



↔ 13 in (33 cm)

🏠 5–7 oz (142–200 g)

⊗ Locally common

🐛 Insect larvae

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NW. to SW. South America

< FEMALE FLICKER
The striking black mustache combined with the red patch on the back of the neck identifies this flicker as female.

long, barred tail